# Steps of Evidence Based Practice

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# Outlines:

1- Introduction.

2. Elements of Evidence-Based Practice in nursing.

3. Advantages and Importance of Evidence-Based Practice in nursing.

4. Steps of Evidence-Based Nursing Process.

5- The process of Evidence Based Practice .

**Introduction:**

❖ Evidence-based practice in nursing is an approach to providing nursing care that uses the most current research available to improve safety, health, and well-being to patients. This practice focuses on delivering high-quality patient care while reducing healthcare costs and variations in patient.

❖ EBP in nursing focuses on integration of clinical expertise including the knowledge, critical reasoning, and judgment skills acquired through nursing training and professional experiences.

➢ **The Elements (the 3 Components) of Evidence-Based Practice in nursing :**

**The Elements (the 3 Components) of Evidence-Based Practice:**

1- Best external evidence: Evaluate and implement the most current, clinically relevant, and scientifically sound research.

2- Individual clinical expertise: Draw on your personal experience of what has worked and not worked in your clinical practice.

3- Patient values and expectations: Consider and value the preferences of your patients.

☒ **Advantage of EBP in nursing**:

➢ **Importance of EBP in nursing:**

1. Provide practicing nurses with evidence-based data.
2. Resolve problems in the clinical setting.
3. Achieve excellence in care delivery.
4. Reduce variations in nursing care.
5. Resolve regulatory problems.
6. Provide valid and up to date information and clinical performance.

**The Difference between Evidence-Based Practice in Nursing and Research In Nursing?**

• Research in nursing is used to validate existing nursing knowledge based on theory and generate new knowledge to promote better nursing practices and favorable patient outcomes.

• While most of the best evidence used in nursing practice stems from nursing research, EBP in nursing goes further to translate evidence from research and apply it to clinical nursing practices.

- **Skills Required For Evidence-Based Practice In Nursing:**

1- Critical Thinking .

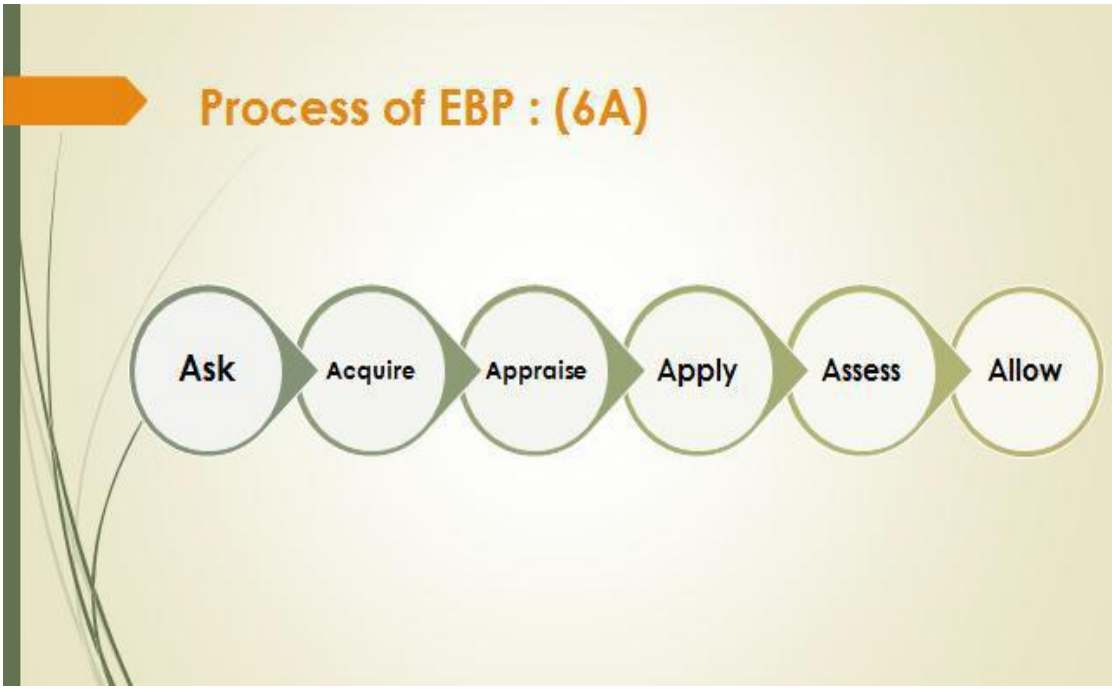
2- Scientific Mindset .

3-Effective Written and Verbal Communication.

4- Ability to Identify Knowledge Gaps.

5-Ability to Integrate Findings into Practice Relevant to the Patient‘s Problem.

**The process of Evidence Based Practice (6A) :**




**What Are the 6 Steps of the process of Evidence-Based Practice?**

**Step1- Ask:** formulate answerable clinical questions about a patient, problem, intervention or outcome.

➢ The question should be in **PICOT** or **PICO** format (use to break down the question into smaller parts and identify keywords).

➢ **P: Patient / Population:**

- Who are the relevant patients?
- Age, sex, geographic location, or specific characteristics that would be important to question. What is the management strategy, diagnostic test, or exposure that are interested.

➢ **I: Intervention /Indicator:**

- What is the management strategy, diagnostic test, or exposure that are interested in?

➢ **C: Compare / Control:**

- Is there a control or alternative management strategy you would like to compare to the intervention or indicator?

➢ **O: Outcome:**

- What is the patient-relevant consequences of the intervention?

➢ **T:Time / Type of Study or Question:**

- What time periods should be considered?
- What study types are most likely to have the information you seek?
- What clinical domain does question fall under?

➢ **Step 2- Acquire:** search for relevant evidence to answer questions.

- Search and select the appropriate resources to find the best evidence to answer the questions.

➢ **The resources divided into 3 categories:**

1- General information (background) resources.
2- Filtered resources.
3- Unfiltered resources.

**1- General information (background) resources.**

This category contains resources that provide background information about various clinical questions. Resources include up to- date and other E-Books, textbook format, journal literature.

**2- Filtered resources** are secondary sources that summarize and analyze the available evidence.

- **filtered resources** include, Cochrane Database of Systematic Reviews, Guidelines International Network.

3- **Unfiltered resources** are primary or original sources that provide evidence concerning a topic under investigation. unfiltered resources include, Web of Science, Scopus and PubMed.

**Step 3- Appraise:** determine whether or not the evidence is high – quality and valuable.

(critically judging the trustworthiness and relevance of the evidence).

Critical appraisal is the process of systematically examining research evidence to assess its validity, results, and relevance before using it to inform a decision.

## Techniques for critical appraisal:

**1- Validity (is the study valid)?**

validity is a way to assess the quality of a research study. Validity refers to how accurately a method measures, what it is intended to measure.

**2- Relevance (How will the results help working with the patient?)**

The research covered the outcome for patients and the outcomes are patients oriented or disease oriented.

**3- The results (What are the results?).**

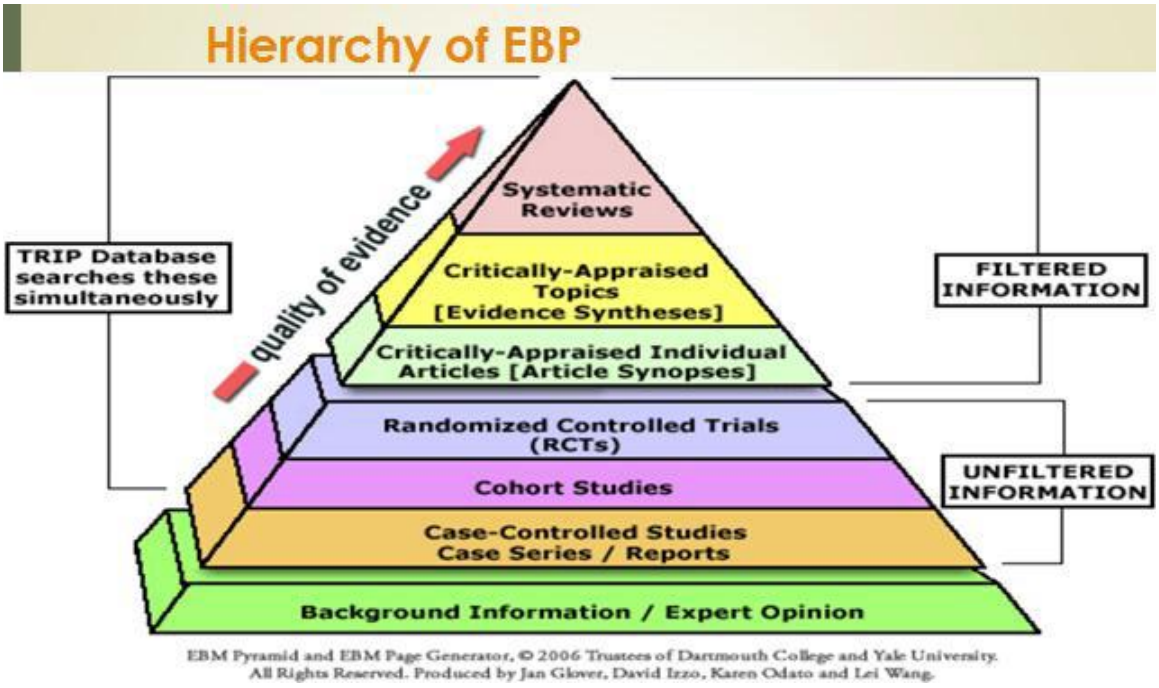
Reading the results aims at deciding whether it is worth to change to the new modality of treatment or not.

**Step 4- Apply:** make clinical decisions utilizing he best available evidence. (incorporating the evidence into the decision-making process).

**To achieve a measurable improvement when the implementation criteria are met:**

□ Quality of patient care.
□ Consistency of patient care.
□ Patient outcomes.
□ Cost containment.

**Step 5- Assess:** evaluate the outcome of applying the evidence to the patient's situation.

**Step 6- Allow**: Dissemination the outcomes of the EBP decision or change through presentation or publication.

### ❖ Levels of Evidence: